attention. Data should be recorded in the documents accurately and completely.

2. Storage of Records: The storage is concerned with the classification of records and then filing in the suitable filing equipment which is in the easily accessible location. Arrangement should also be made to protect the records against disaster or unauthorized use.

3. Retrieval of record: The records are store for further use. An efficient procedure must be established so that records may be retrieved and delivered in time. The utilization of records is greatly influenced by the mode of their creation.

4. Disposal of records: The last stage in the record cycle is the disposal stage which is concerned with preserving valuable documents and disposing the expired documents. A record retention schedule classifies records based on the time period and the requirement of the same.

5.3.1. Objectives of Record Management:

The basic objective of records management as given by **Leffingwell and Robinson** are as follows:

1. To keep an Orderly Account of Progress: The purpose of writing down and preserving memoranda of transactions, (financial and other kinds) various documents, papers, correspondent etc, are to record the progress of the business. This may be referred to as historical function of records.

2. To Facilitate Comparison: Records facilitate comparison between one period of time and another, between different product lines and between firms operating in different lines of business. This analytical function of records play a vital role in today's business.

3. To Detect Errors and Wastes: Errors and wastes can be known and controlled only with the help of proper records and management. Records management is a control function which facilitates the evolution of techniques for the elimination of errors and waste.

4. Legal Formalities: Certain records are to be kept for a specified period of time under the provisions of the various Acts. For instance, sales records have to be kept for several years under the Sales Tax Act, Receipts and Payment vouchers and accounts books have to be kept for several years under the Income Tax Act and so on.

5.4. Filing:

Filing can be described as the core of records management. It is rightly said that the keystone of office organization is the maintenance of comprehensive, simple and efficient filing system. Filing cannot be treated as an unimportant function of the office, perhaps it is the most important amongst its functions. **Denyer** gives a very simple definition of filing. He describes it as the "process of arranging and storing records so that they can be located when required, "thus filling as process has following major objectives (i) Proper arrangement of records, (ii) Careful storing of records, (iii). Easy availability of records without these objectives in view, filing system will not be useful and so the organization can not function successfully.

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